

See also

Find out about the orangutan (130–131), who also takes a long time to raise a small number of babies but can keep breeding for many years.

In their first year, wandering albatrosses are brown with white faces. They become whiter with age.

Leaving the nest

It takes around nine months for the chick to be old enough to fly and be independent. By this time, the parents are exhausted and will not breed again until the year after next.

Caring for their chick

The chick hatches with white downy feathers and grows quickly on a diet of fish and squid. Mother and father continue to share their parental duties—including fishing in the seas around the island.

Some albatrosses can still breed at 70 years of age.

Albatrosses have a good sense of smell, helping them track fishy meals.

Building a nest

Mother and father collect mud and grass to make a nest. They incubate their single egg for 78 days, taking turns sitting on the nest for two to three weeks at a time.